

City Story & Historical Context — Living Legacy Integration

The Vision

Every city in MWM has a STORY — just like every business has a profile card. The historical context we've written for each city (the rich paragraphs about migration history, cultural significance, key neighborhoods, and diaspora contributions) should be a first-class feature in the app, not just internal documentation.

When a user enters Philadelphia, they should feel the WEIGHT of that city's history before they even tap a pin. The city itself has a legacy. The businesses and landmarks exist WITHIN that legacy. The historical context is the connective tissue.

Where It Lives in the App

1. Living Legacy Page — City Story Header

The Living Legacy section for each city opens with the City Story at the top:

Plain Text



LIVING LEGACY: PHILADELPHIA

[Hero Image – city cultural photo]

"Philadelphia has been a significant center for the Black diaspora since the 17th century..."

[Read Full History ▼]

CULTURAL SITES & LANDMARKS (10)

1

2

3

...

COMMUNITY STORIES

[User-submitted content]

- The brief context (2-3 sentences) is always visible
- "Read Full History" expands to show the complete historical context
- Below the City Story: cultural sites, landmarks, community stories, ambassador content

2. First Visit Welcome (One-Time)

The FIRST time a user enters a new city (either physically or by browsing), show a brief welcome card:

Plain Text

Welcome to Philadelphia

"A city that has been home to the Black diaspora since the 17th century – from the Underground Railroad to 4,500+ murals honoring African American heroes."

[Explore Living Legacy] [Dismiss]

- Shows ONCE per city per user (store in user preferences)
- Dismissible — never blocks the experience
- "Explore Living Legacy" takes them to the full page

3. Searchable

If a user searches:

- "Philadelphia history" → surfaces the City Story
- "why Philadelphia" → surfaces the City Story
- "Black history Philadelphia" → surfaces the City Story + relevant cultural landmarks

The historical context is indexed content, not hidden metadata.

Database Schema

Option A: Extend `city_launches` table

SQL

```
ALTER TABLE city_launches ADD COLUMN historical_context TEXT;
ALTER TABLE city_launches ADD COLUMN brief_context TEXT;
ALTER TABLE city_launches ADD COLUMN why_mwm_here TEXT;
ALTER TABLE city_launches ADD COLUMN hero_image_url TEXT;
ALTER TABLE city_launches ADD COLUMN city_story_updated_at TIMESTAMP;
```

Option B: New `city_profiles` table (recommended if `city_launches` is getting bloated)

SQL

```
CREATE TABLE city_profiles (
  id SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
  city_slug VARCHAR(100) REFERENCES city_launches(slug),
  historical_context TEXT NOT NULL,
  brief_context TEXT NOT NULL,
  why_mwm_here TEXT,
  hero_image_url TEXT,
  key_neighborhoods TEXT[], -- e.g., ['Germantown', 'West Philadelphia', 'North
  key_figures TEXT[], -- e.g., ['Richard Allen', 'Octavius Catto', 'Marian Ande
  migration_era VARCHAR(50), -- e.g., 'Great Migration', 'Post-Civil War', 'Mod
  cultural_anchors TEXT[], -- from the Kinfolk Cultural Anchors data you alread
  created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT NOW(),
  updated_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT NOW()
);
```

Seed Data

All the historical context already exists in the Cultural Guide documents (Parts 1, 2, and 3). Each city has:

- `historical_context` — the full 2-paragraph overview (already written)
- `brief_context` — extract the first 2-3 sentences from the historical context
- `why_mwm_here` — the "Why MWM Should Be Here" paragraph (already written)
- `key_neighborhoods` — mentioned in the historical context
- `cultural_anchors` — already in the `city_dialect_profiles` table

Write a seed script that extracts this data from the Cultural Guide content and populates the table for all cities.

API Endpoints

GET /cities/:slug/story

Returns the city profile for display on the Living Legacy page:

JSON

```
{
  "city": "Philadelphia",
  "state": "PA",
  "slug": "philadelphia",
  "brief_context": "Philadelphia has been a significant center for the Black di",
  "historical_context": "[Full 2-paragraph text]",
  "why_mwm_here": "[Strategic value paragraph]",
  "hero_image_url": null,
  "key_neighborhoods": ["Germantown", "West Philadelphia", "North Philadelphia"],
  "key_figures": ["Richard Allen", "Octavius Catto", "Marian Anderson"],
  "cultural_anchors": ["Underground Railroad", "Mother Bethel AME", "4500+ mura",
  "business_count": 15,
  "cultural_site_count": 10,
  "community_story_count": 0
}
```

GET /cities/:slug/welcome

Returns the brief welcome card data (for first-visit display):

JSON

```
{
  "city": "Philadelphia",
  "brief_context": "A city that has been home to the Black diaspora since the 1",
  "business_count": 15,
  "has_seen": false
}
```

POST /cities/:slug/welcome/dismiss

Marks the welcome card as seen for this user (don't show again for this city).

Mobile UI Placement

Living Legacy Tab (existing)

The Living Legacy tab should now have this structure:

1. **City Story** (top) — brief context visible, expandable to full
2. **Cultural Sites & Landmarks** — the pins with cultural_landmark or heritage_site designation
3. **Community Stories** — user-submitted videos, photos, and narratives about this city
4. **Cultural Ambassadors** — ambassador content filmed in this city

Map View Integration

When a user is viewing the map in a city, add a subtle banner or floating button:

Plain Text

[📖 Philadelphia's Story – Tap to learn the history]

This links to the Living Legacy page. It's non-intrusive but always accessible.

Content Hierarchy

The City Story is the TOP of the content hierarchy for a city:

Plain Text

CITY

- └ City Story (historical context, brief + full)
- └ Cultural Sites & Landmarks (pins with heritage_site/cultural_landmark designation)
- └ Businesses (pins with business designation)
 - └ Verified Businesses
 - └ Community Entrepreneurs
- └ Community Stories (user-generated content)
- └ Cultural Ambassador Content (creator videos)
- └ Kinfolk City Context (dialect phrases, local voice)

Everything flows FROM the City Story. The landmarks exist because of that history. The businesses exist because of those communities. The community stories are the CONTINUATION of that legacy.

What This Is NOT

- This is NOT a Wikipedia page. It's curated, emotional, and community-focused.
 - This is NOT static forever. As community members add their own stories, the City Story can evolve. The founder can update it after visiting. Cultural Ambassadors can add video versions.
 - This is NOT mandatory reading. Users can skip it entirely and just browse pins. But it's always there for those who want to understand WHY this city matters.
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Implementation Priority

This is a **Phase 2** feature (post-Apple-approval, pre-tour):

- The data already exists (we wrote it)
- The table is a simple addition
- The API endpoint is straightforward
- The mobile UI is a header section on an existing page

Estimated effort: 1-2 days for schema + seed + API + basic mobile display.

VERIFICATION

Please confirm:

1. Where will the City Story appear in the current app navigation? (Which tab/screen?)
2. Will the historical context be searchable by users?
3. How will you handle cities that don't have a city_profile yet? (Graceful fallback?)
4. When the founder visits a city on tour and wants to UPDATE the City Story with her own observations, how does she do that? (Admin panel? In-app edit?)